

missed qualifying for the final by microseconds, while the women's 4x400m relay team delivered a disappointing performance, failing to leave any mark on the competition.

Several of India's current national champions, expected to make an impact, also faltered.

Asian Games champion Annu Rani (women's javelin), Tajinderpal Singh Toor (shot put), Praveen Chithravel (triple jump), Jyothi Yarraji (100m hurdles), Jeswin Aldrin (long jump), and Parul Chaudhary (3,000m steeplechase) all failed to qualify for the finals, falling far short of their



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qualification marks.

Avinash Sable, the men's 3,000m steeplechase national record holder, was the only other Indian to reach a final, finishing 11th in his event. No other athlete achieved a personal best at the Olympics, and only Parul Chaudhary secured a season's best (in both the 3,000m steeplechase and 5,000m).

The result was particularly disappointing given that India had a promising build-up to the Olympics. From the start of the season until the end of the Olympic qualification period, eight outdoor national records were set. Athletics Federation of India president Adille Sumariwalla admitted that he was disappointed by the overall result.

There would be further disappointment at the Junior World Championships in Lima, Peru, where India finished with just one medal — in the women's 10km race walk. India made the finals in just four



events, and only one athlete, Sharukh Khan in the men's 3,000m steeplechase, set a new national record.

The Federation has talked about revamping the qualification system. Rather than peaking at one competition, Indian athletes will have to compete multiple times in India, earning points that will ultimately determine their spot on the Indian team for the upcoming season.

While the Federation is

attempting something innovative in hopes of improving India's performances, plenty of perennial issues remain.

Over the course of the season, several promising Indian athletes, including Manu DP (who finished sixth at the World Championships in the javelin throw), and Parvej Khan (who set an Indian record in the mile), failed drug tests and face lengthy bans.

It remains to be seen what the